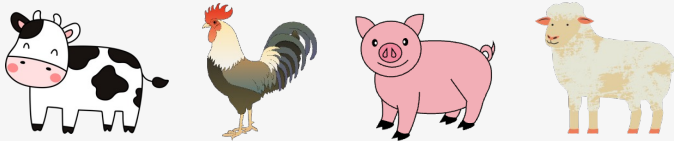


Compassion Heals

Chloe Barker



How Plant-Based Diets Can Prevent Disease and Protect Animals

Chronic Disease in America

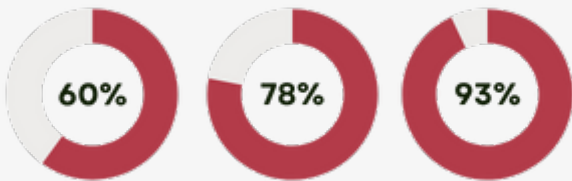
The top three leading causes of death in the U.S include:

- heart disease
- diabetes
- cancer



Chronic illness is the norm, not the exception.

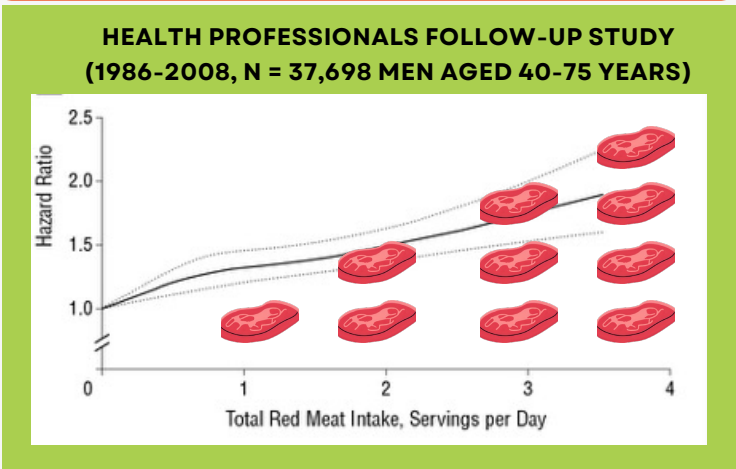
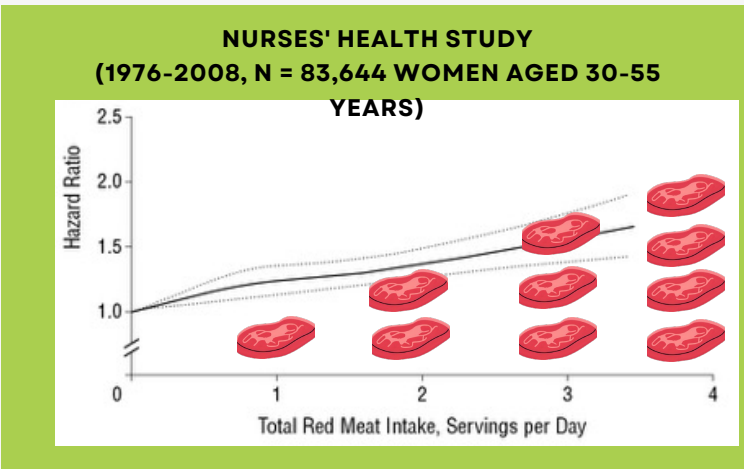
- 6 in 10 young adults (59.5%)
- 8 in 10 midlife adults (78.4%)
- 9 in 10 older adults (93.0%)



Reported having at least one chronic condition (CDC, 2023)

Meat and Mortality

More red meat = Higher mortality risk



Red meat is linked to:

- Increased mortality rate
- Higher risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease

Health is wealth

Take care of your body

Meat Consumption	Risk Increase of Type 2 Diabetes
50-g/day processed meat consumption	51%
100-g/day unprocessed red meat consumption	19%

Plants Can Prevent It



What is a plant-based diet?

- A plant-based diet focuses on whole foods from plants - vegetables, fruits, legumes, grains, nuts, and seeds - and minimizes consumption of animal products.

★ Supported by the American Dietetic Association as nutritionally adequate for all life stages.

Plant-based diets can reduce risk of:

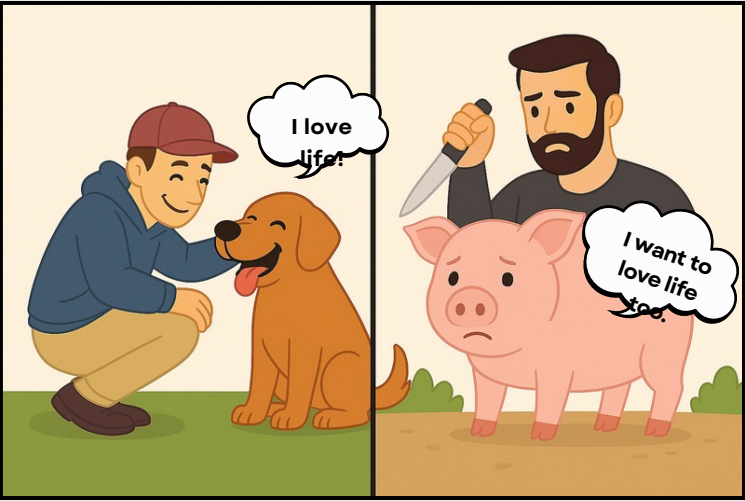
- ↓ Cardiovascular Disease by 30% (Huang et al., 2012)
- ↓ Type 2 Diabetes by 25% (Satija et al., 2016)
- ↓ Colorectal Cancer by 20%
- ↓ Hypertension, Kidney Disease, Acne (Hou et al., 2022; Fusano, 2023)
- ↓ Inflammation and Obesity (Menzel et al., 2020)
- ↓ Harmful compounds like TMAO (Constantino-Jonapa et al., 2023)



Vegetarian & vegan diets are associated with decreased mortality rates and reduced risk for chronic diseases.

Beyond Your Plate

- **83 billion** animals are slaughtered for meat production globally per year (FAOUN)
- Over **1 million** animals are eaten *per hour* in the U.S. (USDA)
- **Ethical concern:** Why do we love some animals and eat others?



ANIMAL AGRICULTURE: THE HIDDEN COST OF OUR PLATES.

Takeaway & Action

health → ethics → action

Why It Matters

- You can **improve** your **health**.
- You can **save** animal **lives**.
- You can **lower** your **footprint**.
- **Compassion** is **contagious** & **feeling good** is **forever**.



What You Can Do Today

- **Start small:** Try **Meatless Mondays**
- Explore swaps like **lentils, tofu, or chickpea pasta** to meet nutritional needs.
- Focus on progress, not perfection.
- **Share this info.**

References

CDC, Constantino-Jonapa et al., 2023, Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, Fusano, 2023, Hou et al., 2022, Huang et al., 2012, Menzel et al., 2020, Pan et al., 2012, Satija et al., 2016, USDA

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